

2.10.52

EE25BTECH11023 - Venkata Sai

Question:

Let $\mathbf{a} = \hat{\mathbf{i}} + 2\hat{\mathbf{j}} + \hat{\mathbf{k}}$, $\mathbf{b} = \hat{\mathbf{i}} - \hat{\mathbf{j}} + \hat{\mathbf{k}}$ and $\mathbf{c} = \hat{\mathbf{i}} + \hat{\mathbf{j}} - \hat{\mathbf{k}}$. A vector in the plane of $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ whose projection on $\mathbf{c}$ is $\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$, is

1) $4\hat{\mathbf{i}} - \hat{\mathbf{j}} + 4\hat{\mathbf{k}}$

2) $3\hat{\mathbf{i}} + \hat{\mathbf{j}} - 3\hat{\mathbf{k}}$

3) $2\hat{\mathbf{i}} + \hat{\mathbf{j}} - 2\hat{\mathbf{k}}$

4) $4\hat{\mathbf{i}} + \hat{\mathbf{j}} - 4\hat{\mathbf{k}}$

Solution:

Given

$$\mathbf{a} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{c} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (1)$$

Let $\mathbf{r}$ be coplanar to $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$

$$\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{a} + t\mathbf{b} \quad (2)$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} + t \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1+t \\ 2-t \\ 1+t \end{pmatrix} \quad (3)$$

Given the projection of $\mathbf{r}$ on $\mathbf{c}$ is $\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$

$$\frac{\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{c}}{\|\mathbf{c}\|} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \quad (4)$$

$$\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{c} = \mathbf{r}^T \mathbf{c} = \begin{pmatrix} 1+t & 2-t & 1+t \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (5)$$

$$= 1+t+2-t-1-t = 2-t \quad (6)$$

$$\|\mathbf{c}\|^2 = \mathbf{c}^T \mathbf{c} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (7)$$

$$= 1+1+1 = 3 \quad (8)$$

$$\frac{|2-t|}{\sqrt{3}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \quad (9)$$

yielding

$$(2 - t) = \pm 1 \quad (10)$$

$$\implies t = 1 \text{ or } 3 \quad (11)$$

When $t=1$, we have

$$\mathbf{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (12)$$

When $t=3$, we have

$$\mathbf{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ -1 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} \quad (13)$$

Hence Option(1) is the correct answer

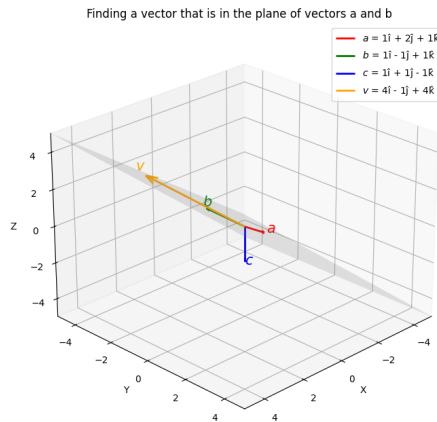


Fig. 4.1